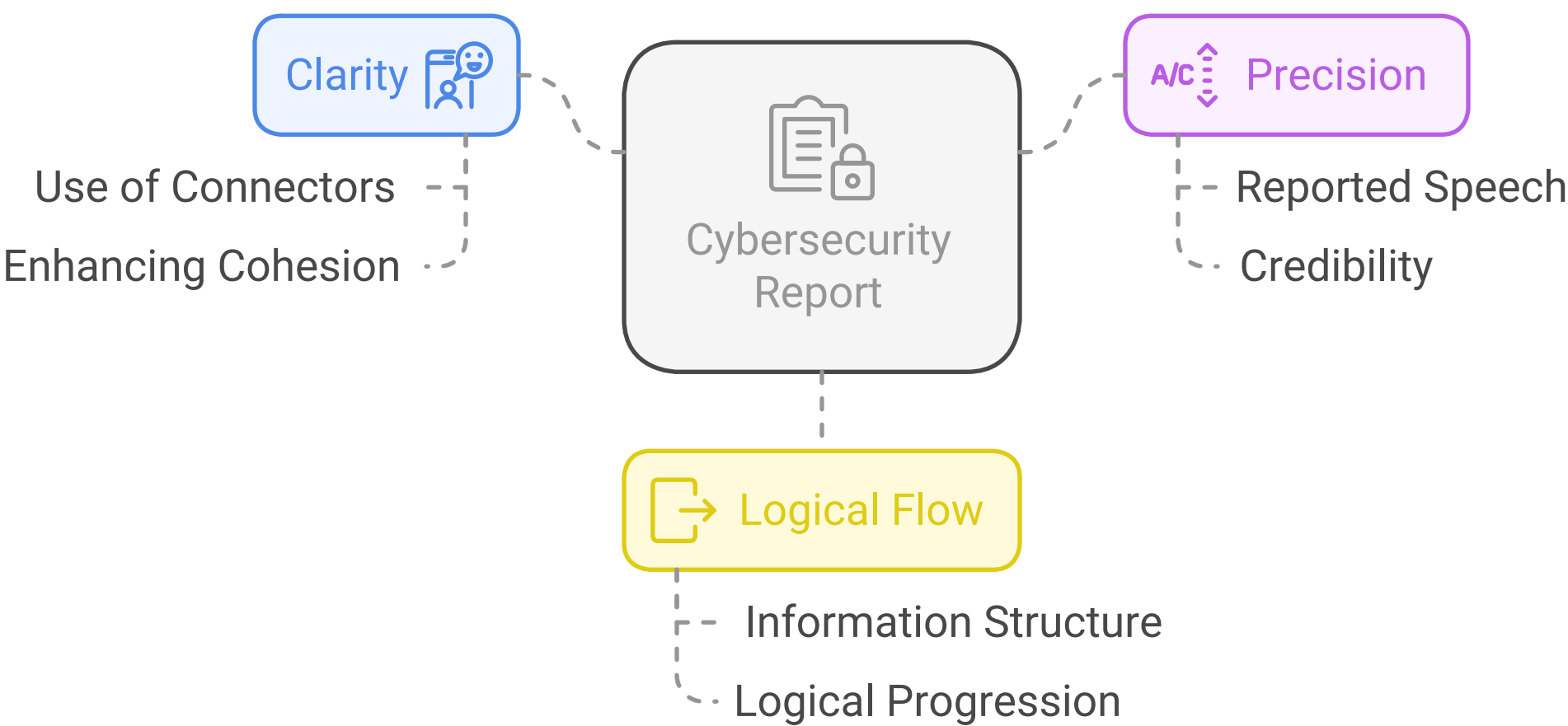


Tips for Writing a Strong Cyberattack Report

Writing a cybersecurity report requires **clarity, precision, and a logical flow** of information. Below are essential **tips** to help you structure a well-organized and professional report. Pay special attention to the use of **connectors** and **reported speech** to enhance cohesion and credibility.

Writing a Cybersecurity Report: Key Components



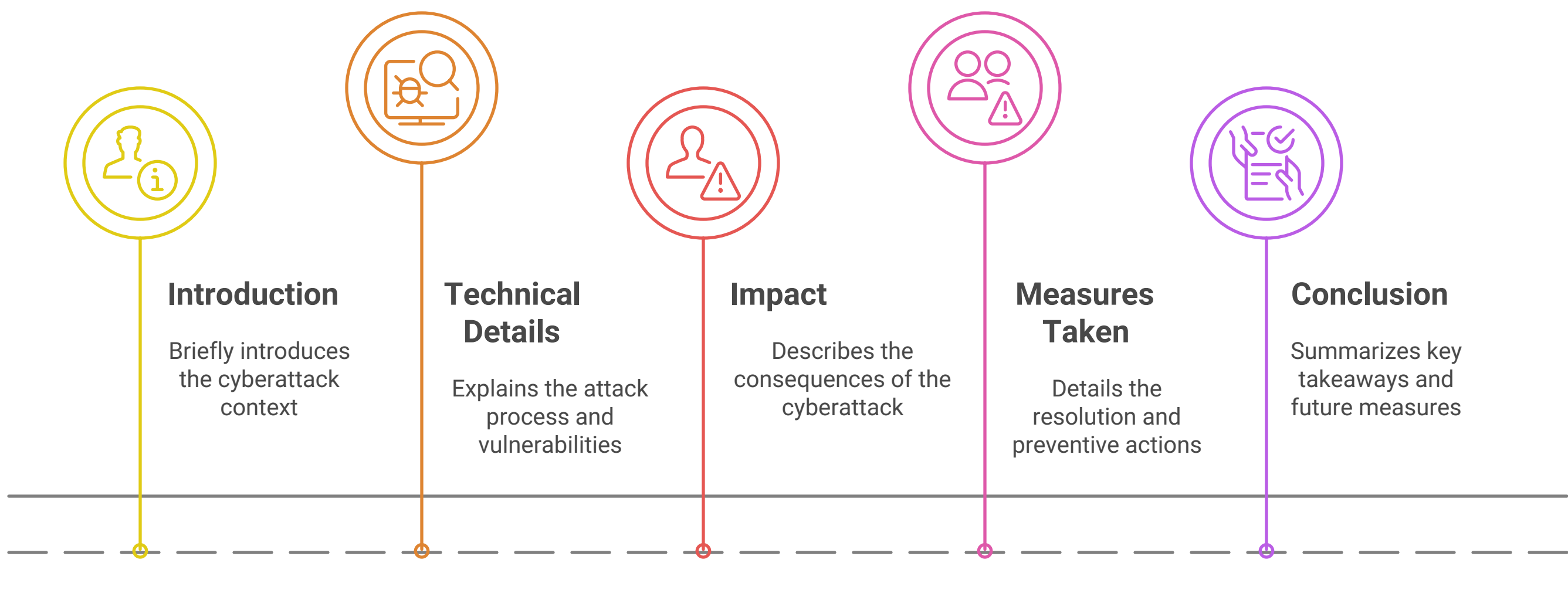
1. Structure Your Report Logically

A well-structured report should include **five key sections**:

- ◊ **Introduction (50 words)** – Provide general context and introduce the cyberattack briefly.
- ◊ **Technical Details (80 words)** – Explain how the attack happened and the vulnerabilities exploited.
- ◊ **Impact (60 words)** – Describe the consequences of the attack.
- ◊ **Measures Taken (60 words)** – Detail how the issue was resolved and preventive actions.
- ◊ **Conclusion (50 words)** – Summarize key takeaways and propose future security measures.

Use sequencing connectors to maintain logical order: *"Initially, the malware targeted sensitive data. Subsequently, it spread across the network, affecting critical services. Following this, security experts developed a patch to prevent further damage."*

Cyberattack Report Sequence



2. Use Reported Speech for Expert Opinions

Your report should **cite cybersecurity experts, organizations, or official statements** using **reported speech** to enhance credibility.

How to use reported speech correctly:



Citing Experts



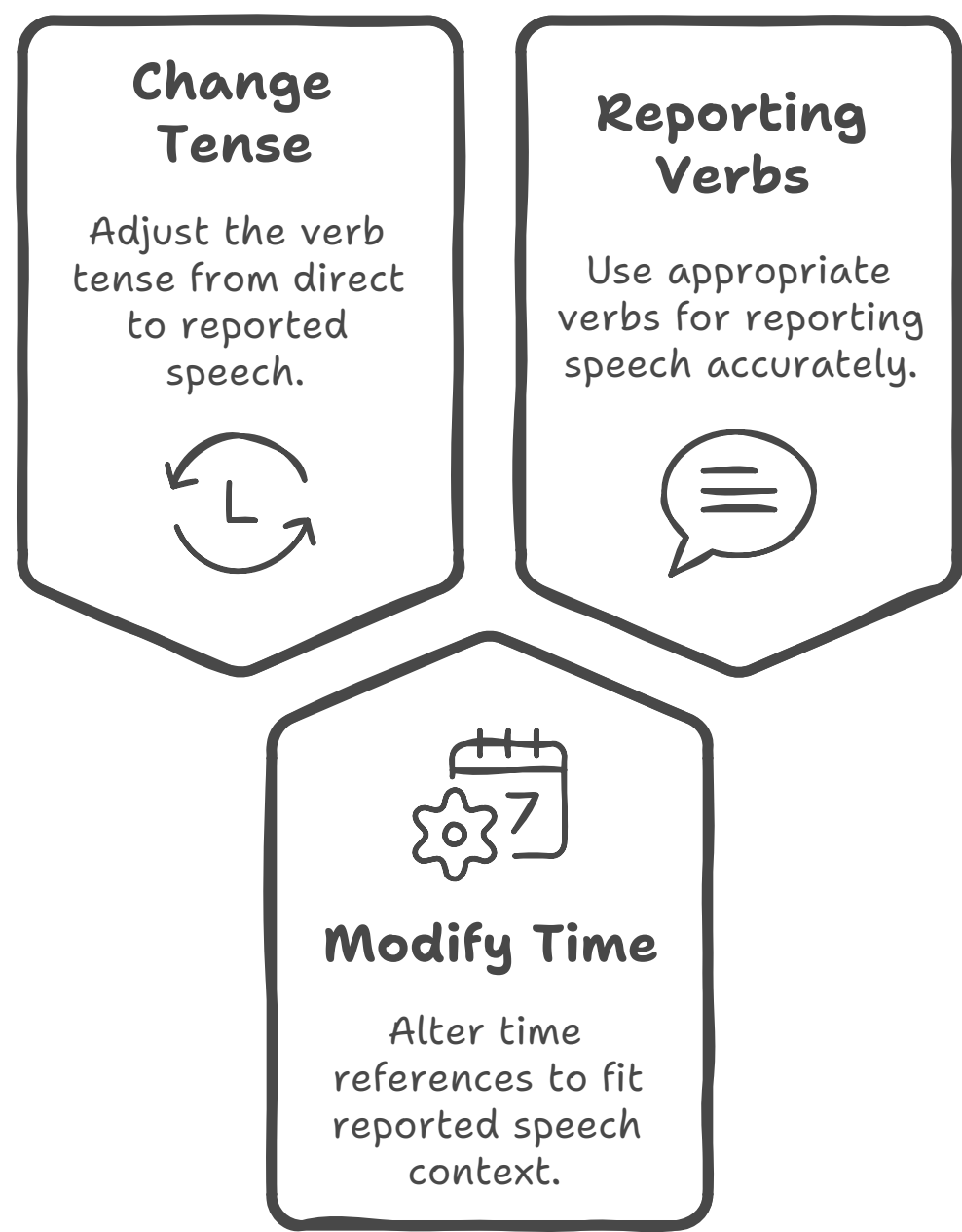
Referencing Organizations



Official Statements

- **Change the verb tense:**
 - *Direct speech:* "The CEO said, 'This is the most serious breach we have faced.'"*
 - *Reported speech:* **The CEO stated that it was the most serious breach they had faced.**
- **Modify time references if necessary:**
 - *Direct speech:* "The security expert explained, 'The attack occurred yesterday.'"
 - *Reported speech:* **The security expert explained that the attack had occurred the previous day.**
- **Use reporting verbs like:** ♦ *stated, reported, explained, admitted, confirmed, announced, warned, emphasized*

Reporting Speech Conversion

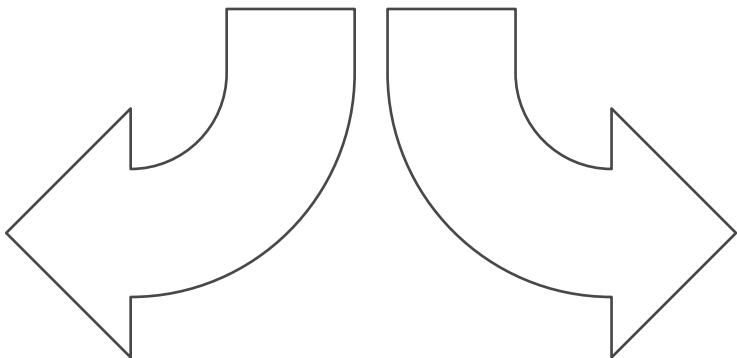


Example in context: *"Cybersecurity experts warned that this type of ransomware attack was becoming more frequent and recommended that companies implement stronger firewalls."*

How should companies respond to the increasing frequency of ransomware attacks?

Implement Stronger Firewalls

Strengthening firewalls can provide enhanced protection against ransomware attacks.



Ignore Warnings

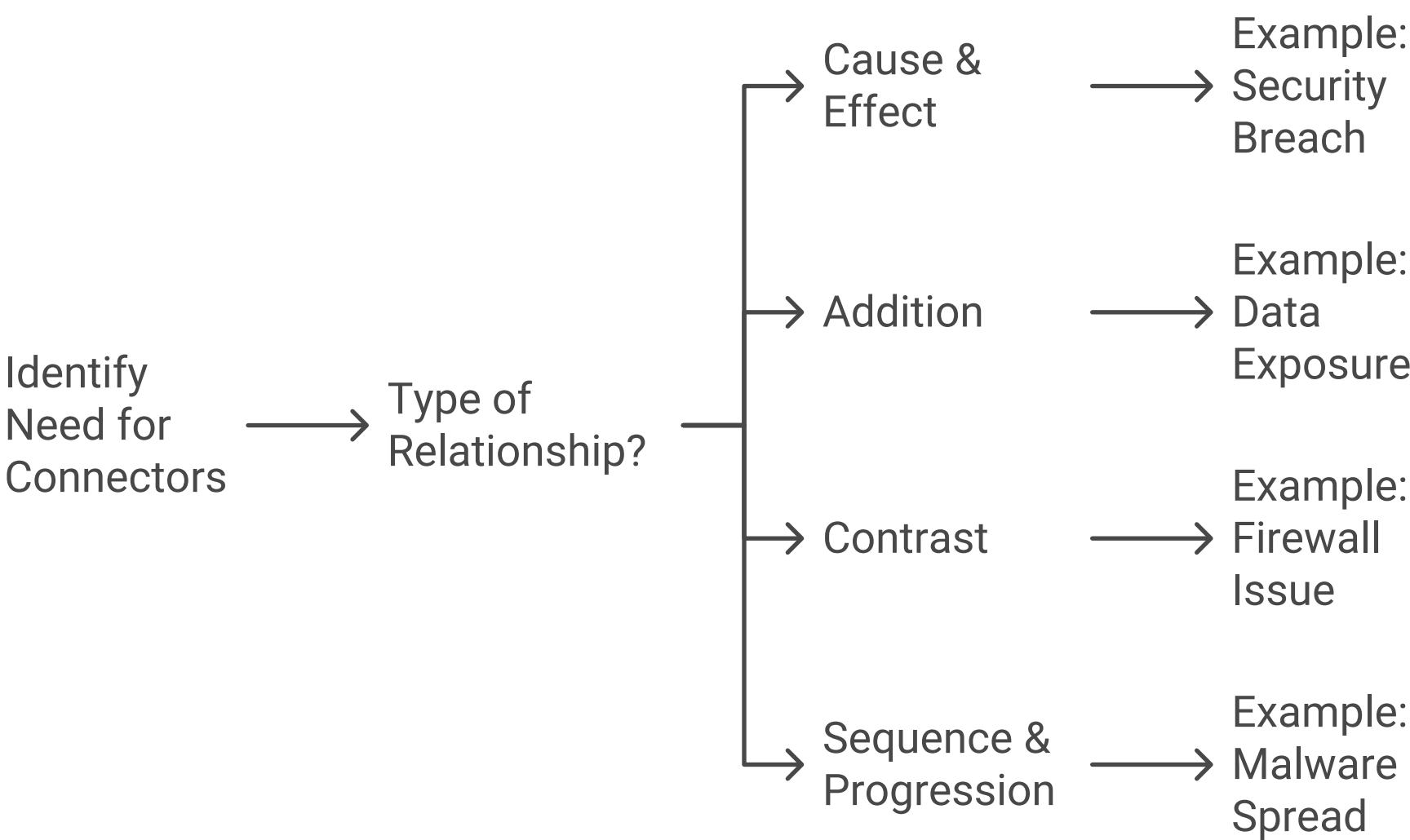
Ignoring expert warnings may lead to increased vulnerability and potential data loss.

3. Use a Variety of Connectors for Clarity and Cohesion

A strong report needs **logical connectors** to show relationships between ideas. Use them strategically:

- A. Cause & Effect (To explain why something happened)
 - **As a result, Consequently, Due to, Owing to, Therefore**
 - *Example:* "Due to outdated security protocols, hackers were able to exploit system vulnerabilities."
- B. Addition (To add more information)
 - **Moreover, Furthermore, In addition to that, Not only that**
 - *Example:* "The breach exposed financial records. Moreover, it compromised personal employee data."
- C. Contrast (To highlight differences or unexpected results)
 - **However, Nevertheless, Despite this, Although, Even though**
 - *Example:* "The company had a firewall in place. However, it was not configured properly."
- D. Sequence & Progression (To structure the timeline of the attack)
 - **Initially, Subsequently, Following this, At first, Later on, Eventually**
 - *Example:* "At first, the malware remained undetected. Subsequently, it spread across the entire system."

Using Logical Connectors in Reports



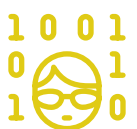
4. Use Phrasal Verbs to Sound More Natural

Phrasal verbs make your writing **more engaging and natural** in a professional context:

✓ **Break into** [gain unauthorized access] → "Hackers broke into the company's server through a phishing email." ✓ **Carry out** [execute an attack] → "The attackers carried out a sophisticated cyber operation." ✓ **Look into** [investigate] → "The security team is looking into the cause of the breach." ✓ **Patch up** [fix a security flaw] → "The IT department patched up the vulnerability." ✓ **Fend off** [defend against an attack] → "The company managed to fend off the second wave of attacks."

👉 **Use at least three phrasal verbs in your report to demonstrate fluency.**

Phrasal Verbs in Cybersecurity



Break into

Gain unauthorized access example.



Carry out

Execute an attack example.



Look into

Investigate a breach example.



Patch up

Fix a security flaw example.



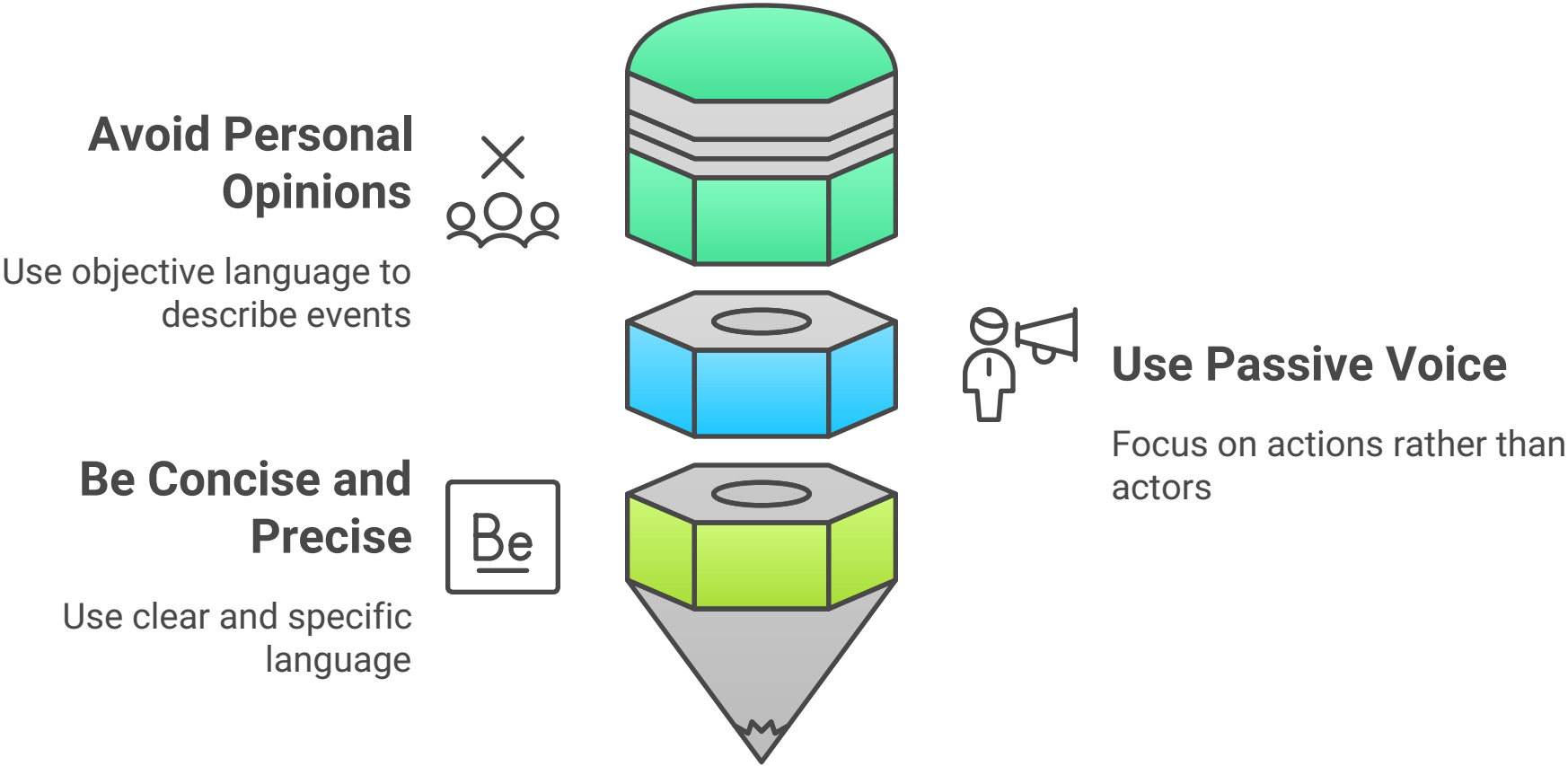
Fend off

Defend against an attack example.

5. Keep the Tone Formal and Objective

♦ Avoid personal opinions: Instead of "I think the attack was serious," say "**The attack was classified as a severe security breach.**" ♦ Use **passive voice** to focus on actions rather than who performed them: "Sensitive data was encrypted by the malware." ♦ Be **concise and precise**. Avoid vague words like "stuff," "a lot," "things."

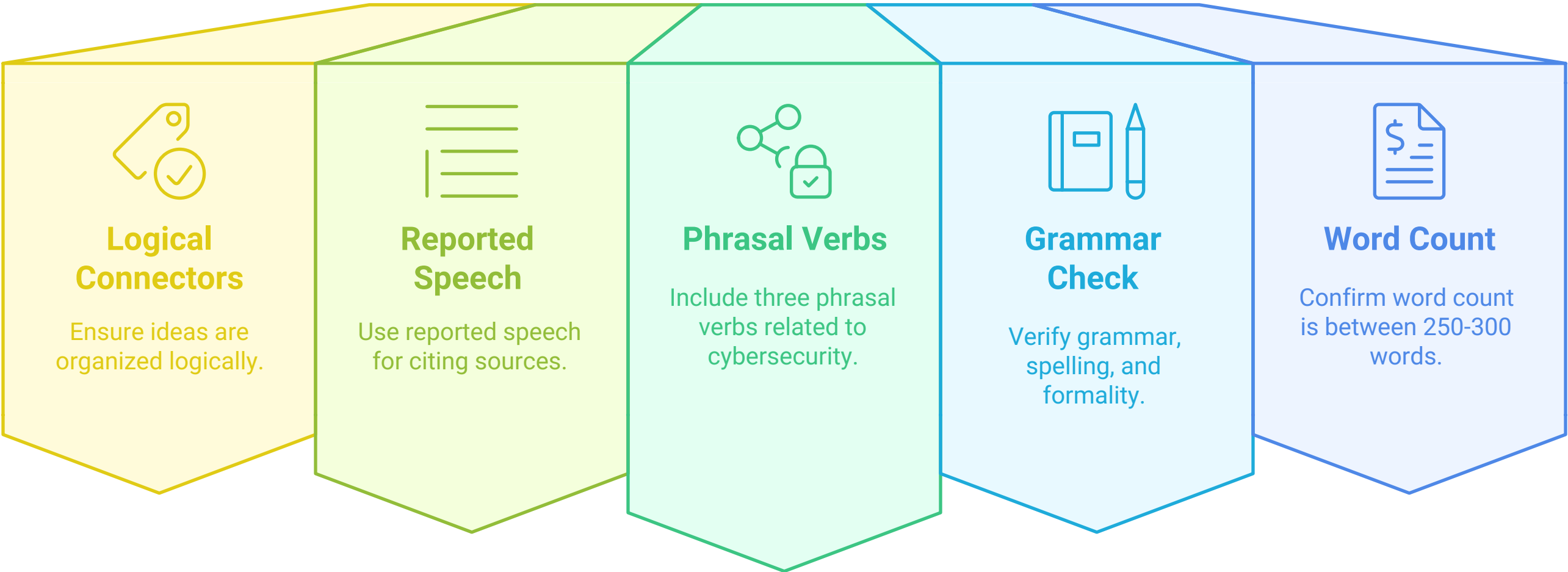
Effective Cyberattack Report Writing



Final Checklist Before Submission

Did you use **logical connectors** to organize your ideas? Did you incorporate **reported speech** when citing sources? Did you use at least **three phrasal verbs** in a cybersecurity context? Did you check **grammar, spelling, and formality**? Is the **word count** between **250-300 words**?

Writing Checklist



Example Report Excerpt

"A recent ransomware attack targeted Hospital General de Catalunya, causing major disruptions to healthcare services. Cybersecurity analysts reported that the attack had been carried out through a phishing email, which an employee had unknowingly opened. Consequently, the malware spread rapidly across the hospital's network, encrypting patient records."

"Experts warned that this type of attack was becoming more frequent. As a result, the hospital had to set up stronger security protocols and back up sensitive data to prevent future incidents. Nevertheless, the financial impact was significant, with losses estimated at over €500,000."

By following these **five tips**, your report will be **well-structured, professional, and grammatically advanced**, showcasing your **B2-C1 writing skills** effectively.

Writing Tips



Tip One

Focus on clarity and conciseness in your writing.



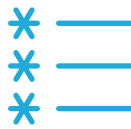
Tip Two

Use varied sentence structures to enhance readability.



Tip Three

Incorporate advanced vocabulary appropriately.



Tip Four

Ensure proper grammar and punctuation throughout.



Tip Five

Organize your report with clear headings and sections.